

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 37

By Lamar

A RESOLUTION to designate October 17 as Maternal Health Day in Tennessee.

WHEREAS, Maternal Health Day celebrates every person's right to respectful, quality, safe, and comprehensive maternal health care, including women of color, rural and urban women, and women living below the poverty line; and

WHEREAS, a significant percentage of all pregnancies worldwide are affected by life-threatening but preventable complications; adolescents are at significant risk for maternal complications, with maternal deaths ranking as a leading cause of death for girls aged fifteen to nineteen; and

WHEREAS, women need integrated, evidence-based, and cost-effective care before, during, and after pregnancy, as women die from complications in pregnancy or childbirth because their healthcare system lacks resources and/or its allocation of health resources overlooks women's needs; and

WHEREAS, Tennessee's maternal mortality rate is significantly higher than the national average; and

WHEREAS, Maternal Health Day seeks to raise awareness of the importance of maternal health and promote skilled and dignified care for all women; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we designate October 17 as Maternal Health Day in Tennessee in support of all women, including women of color, rural and urban women, and women living below the poverty line.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.